



Andrej Verity <andrejverity@gmail.com>

20th Anniversary of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) in Geneva

1 message

Daniel Stauffacher // ICT4Peace Foundation <danielstauffacher@ict4peace.org>

Wed, Dec 20, 2023 at 1:06 AM

Reply-To: Daniel Stauffacher // ICT4Peace Foundation <danielstauffacher@ict4peace.org>

To: andrejverity@gmail.com

[View this email in your browser](#)

20th Anniversary of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) in Geneva

 wsis smsi cmsi 03	 wsis smsi cmsi 03
For further information on WSIS please contact: World Summit on the Information Society Executive Secretariat c/o ITU Place des Nations CH-1211 Geneva 20 Switzerland T +41 22 730 5511 F +41 22 730 6393 Email wsis@itu.int www.itu.int/wsis	 world summit on the information society Geneva 10-12 December 2003 The Geneva Declaration of Principles and Plan of Action

From 10 to 12 December 2003 the UN held the first **World Summit on the Information Society in Geneva**, where Heads of States and Governments approved the Geneva Declaration of Principles and the Geneva Plan of Action for the Information Society.

What was WSIS about ?

The World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) in Geneva represented a first ever global platform to bring together the international community, including Heads of State and Government, Executive Heads of United Nations agencies, national delegates and leaders from non-governmental organizations (NGOs), industry leaders, media representatives and civil society.

During the decade preceding WSIS, the development of new information communication technologies (ICT) has provided a variety of opportunities for people the world over. **However, a vast majority of humanity remained untouched by the digital revolution. There were (and still are today) real disparities between countries and socio-economic groups that are benefiting from information technologies, and those that are not.** By addressing the major social and economic challenges posed by the use of new technologies, the purpose of the Summit was to develop a common vision and understanding of the information society and the adoption of a declaration of principles and a plan of action for concerted development for implementation by governments, international institutions and all sectors of civil society in order to reduce the digital divide.

The World Summit on the Information Society was prepared under the high patronage of the United Nations Secretary-General Kofi Annan, with the International Telecommunication Union (ITU) as the leading organizational agency. The Summit was held in two phases:

The first phase took place between 10-12 December 2003 in Geneva, Switzerland and resulted in the adoption of the **Geneva Declaration of Principles and the Geneva Plan of Action**

The **second phase of the Summit was held on 16 – 18 November 2005 in Tunis** which adopted the **Tunis Commitment and Tunis Agenda for the Information Society**

The Geneva WSIS Summit was organised in close cooperation between the International Telecommunication Union ITU and the Government of Switzerland. Please find here the archived version of the **Official Website of Switzerland, Host of the World Summit on the Information Society Geneva, 10 to 12 December 2003**

A WSIS+10 Review Summit was held in New York in 2015. **The WSIS+ 20 Review will be held in 2025.**

SUPPORT OUR WORK WITH A DONATION >

ICT4Peace is a policy and action-oriented international Foundation. The purpose is to save lives and protect human dignity through Information and Communication Technology. Since 2003 ICT4Peace explores and champions the use of ICTs and new media for peaceful purposes, including for peacebuilding, crisis management and humanitarian operations. Since 2007 ICT4Peace promotes cybersecurity and a peaceful cyberspace through inter alia international negotiations with governments, international

organisations, companies and non-state actors.

OUR MISSION



ICT4Peace took root with pioneering research on the role of ICTs in preventing, responding to and recovering from conflict in 2003 and lead to the adoption of Paragraph 36 by the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) in Tunis in 2005 which recognises “**...the potential of ICTs to promote peace and to prevent conflict which, inter alia, negatively affects achieving development goals. ICTs can be used for identifying conflict situations through early-warning systems preventing conflicts, promoting their peaceful resolution, supporting humanitarian action, including protection of civilians in armed conflicts, facilitating peacekeeping missions, and assisting post conflict peace-building and reconstruction**”.

The **ICT4Peace Foundation** works to promote the practical realisation of Paragraph 36 and looks at the role of ICT in crisis management, covering aspects of early warning and conflict prevention, peace mediation, peacekeeping, peace-building as well as natural disaster management and humanitarian operations.

Download the report of 2005 on the use of Information and Communications Technologies for peacebuilding (ICT4Peace), with a Preface by Kofi A. Annan, former Secretary General of the United Nations.

An updated version of this report, with critical analysis on current policies and practices of ICTs in peacebuilding and crises was published in early 2011. Published in collaboration with the Berkman Center for Internet and Society at Harvard University and GeorgiaTech, **Peacebuilding in the Information Age: Sifting Hype from Reality** can be read [here](#).



Copyright © 2023 ICT4Peace Foundation, All rights reserved.

You are receiving this email because you've shown an interest in getting news, update and information around the ICT4Peace Foundation's work.

Our mailing address is:

ICT4Peace Foundation
[chemin de Sous-Bois 14](#)
Geneva 1202
Switzerland

[Add us to your address book](#)

1/7/24, 2:22 PM

Gmail - 20th Anniversary of the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) in Geneva

You are receiving this email because you've shown an interest in getting news, updates and information around the ICT4Peace Foundation's work. You can **update your preferences** or **unsubscribe from this list**.